ALLIANCE FOR CANCERCARE EQUITY

ACCE

2025 ANNUAL REPORT

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Message From the President & CEO

Dear Supporters, Partners, Volunteers, and Friends,

As we reflect on 2025, we are filled with gratitude and renewed determination. This year has been one of both challenges and growth for Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE). Throughout the year, we continued to witness the urgent and ongoing need for cancer treatment support among vulnerable patients, particularly those facing delays, financial hardship, and barriers in navigating the healthcare system.

In 2025, ACCE received 31 patient support requests from Ghana, and with the generosity of our donors and the commitment of our volunteers and board, we were able to support or continue supporting 21 patients, while advocating for more resources to reach those still waiting for assistance. Behind every request is a person, a family, and a story of resilience, and our mission remains rooted in ensuring that no one is left behind because of inequities in access to care.

This year also marked important organizational milestones. We completed our incorporation and CRA submissions, strengthened our governance and donor communications, and made significant progress in rebranding ACCE to better reflect the professionalism, credibility, and impact of our work. Our website, logo, newsletter, and social media presence were all revitalized, helping us expand our reach and engage a broader community of supporters.

We are especially encouraged by the growth of our volunteer teams and the emergence of student-led ACCE chapters on university campuses. These developments are helping us build a stronger foundation for long-term sustainability and public awareness.

While there is still much to do, 2025 showed us what is possible when compassion is paired with action. We thank every donor, volunteer, patient advocate, board member, and partner who made this work possible.

Together, we are not only supporting treatment, but we are also advancing equity, dignity, and hope.

Sincerely,

Dr Ernest Osei
Founder, President & CEO
Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE)

Our Vision:

No cancer patient is denied high-quality cancer care based on race, religion, or a family's ability to pay.

Our Mission:

To advance equity in the cancer care continuum from prevention to survivorship and to serve patients battling cancer and their families with the financial, emotional and educational support necessary to cope with the life-threatening illness.

Who We Are

Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE) is a registered charity organization in Canada and Ghana to advance equity in cancer care. We firmly believe that no person should die of cancer because the family cannot afford to pay for their treatment. Moreover, the financial situation of a patient's family should never dictate their chances of surviving a cancer diagnosis. Thus, we have taken on a very ambitious cause to pay for the cancer treatment and related cost of patients who are without the financial means to pay for their treatment.

Our Purposes

- To fund the treatment, travel, and related costs for patients with cancer who are without the financial means to receive adequate healthcare services, in Canada and Ghana
- To provide medical equipment for the diagnosis and treatment of cancer patients in non-profit community healthcare centers
- To provide cancer patients and their families with access to mutual support groups and related counselling
- To conduct research into the causes, prevention, screening, diagnosis, control, and management of cancer and other diseases, in Canada and Ghana

About Alliance for CancerCare Equity

Alliance for CancerCare Equity (ACCE) is committed to improving access to cancer care and treatment support for underserved and vulnerable individuals. Our work focuses on reducing inequities in cancer care by helping patients navigate treatment barriers, providing financial support where possible, and mobilizing communities to raise awareness and resources.

We believe that every person deserves timely, compassionate, and equitable access to cancer treatment, regardless of income, location, or circumstance

2025 Program Activities

A. Patient Support and Access to Care

Supporting patients remained at the heart of ACCE's work throughout 2025.

Patient Support Highlights

- 31 patients requested support from ACCE in 2025
- 21 patients were supported or were actively supported by year-end
- 10 patients remained on the waiting list for potential support due to limited funding
- 4 patients from previous years continued receiving support in 2025
- Sadly, 2 patients passed away during the year

In the early part of the year, ACCE noted a growing demand for assistance, with 14 new patient support requests from Ghana received by April and additional applications still in the pipeline. This trend highlighted the increasing pressure on cancer patients and families, as well as the need for stronger and more sustainable funding.

Addressing Treatment Delays

A major challenge reported during the year was the repeated breakdown of radiotherapy and treatment machines at Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital (KATH) and Korle Bu Teaching Hospital (KBTH). These disruptions created serious delays in treatment and, in some cases, worsened patient outcomes.

In one especially concerning case, a patient had to be transferred to Sweden Medical Center after nine months without radiotherapy treatment, during which follow-up testing indicated suspicious cell growth. This case reinforced ACCE's commitment to intervening as early as possible when delays threaten patient survival and quality of life.

ACCE continued to rely on trusted local contacts at KATH and KBTH to help facilitate treatment-related funding and patient coordination.

Patient Navigation

One of the year's most encouraging developments was the involvement of an ACCE-supported patient volunteer who stepped forward to serve as a patient navigator at KBTH. In this role, the volunteer supported patients in:

- Completing ACCE forms
- Understanding treatment-related processes
- Navigating the health system more effectively

This initiative demonstrated the value of peer-based support and highlighted a promising model for the future. ACCE has identified patient navigation as an area for expansion if funding becomes available.

B. Organizational Growth and Capacity Building

Incorporation and Regulatory Milestones

In 2025, ACCE completed a major administrative milestone:

- Incorporation and CRA submissions were completed in May 2025

This was an important step in strengthening the organization's governance, accountability, and long-term operational foundation.

Annual Reporting and Donor Communication

The Board agreed that donors would begin receiving copies of ACCE's Annual Report, helping strengthen transparency and accountability. By August:

- Annual Report and Financial Report copies had been shared with regular donors
- Reports were also made available on the ACCE website

Additionally:

- Volunteers stepped in and were assigned responsibility for the publication of ACCE's newsletter

This created a stronger communication pipeline with donors, supporters, and the wider public.

C. Rebranding and Digital Presence

One of ACCE's most significant developments in 2025 was its rebranding effort, aimed at improving visibility, credibility, and donor engagement.

Rebranding Initiatives Included

- Review and redesign of the ACCE website
- Review and redesign of the ACCE logo
- Refresh of organizational colours and visual identity
- Improved social media branding and posting strategy
- Launch and strengthening of monthly newsletters and blog content
- New charity email addresses for board members
- Introduction of Slack for internal team communication

By December, the rebranding effort had already delivered visible results:

- The website had been revamped
- ACCE's online presence had become more professional, polished, and credible
- Communication systems were more coordinated and efficient

These improvements are expected to support fundraising, partnership development, and public engagement in the years ahead.

D. Volunteer Engagement and Community Mobilization

Volunteer Recruitment

Throughout 2025, ACCE expanded its volunteer base significantly. Recruitment efforts focused on specialized roles that could strengthen outreach, communication, and organizational growth.

By October and December, ACCE had successfully recruited approximately 10 active volunteers, including support in:

- Content design
- Graphic design
- Website support
- Video editing
- Digital communications and social media

Volunteer teams became increasingly active as the year progressed:

- The content design team began producing monthly newsletters and blog content
- The graphic design team supported regular posts across ACCE's social media platforms
- The video editing team was still being organized at year-end to expand visual storytelling capacity

Campus Chapters

ACCE also made exciting progress in youth and campus engagement. In 2025, the organization began creating and supporting student-led ACCE chapters at:

- University of Waterloo (UW)
- Wilfrid Laurier University (WLU)
- University of Guelph (UoG)
- McMaster University
- University of Western Ontario

By December, these campus clubs were described as very active, especially at:

- University of Waterloo
- University of Guelph
- McMaster University
- University of Western Ontario

These chapters represent an important investment in awareness-building, volunteerism, advocacy, and future leadership.

E. Fundraising and Revenue Development

Fundraising remained a central focus throughout 2025 as ACCE sought to expand its impact and meet growing patient needs.

Key Fundraising Strategies in 2025

- Encouraging board members to remain consistent monthly donors
- Encouraging each board member to recruit at least one monthly donor
- Outreach to approximately 150 local churches through support request letters
- Ongoing search for new donor and sponsorship opportunities
- Membership in the Kitchener-Waterloo Chamber of Commerce to strengthen visibility and community presence
- Exploration of sponsorships for future awareness events

The organization continued to emphasize the importance of monthly giving as a stable revenue stream, recognizing that growth in donations is essential to increasing patient support.

F. Cancer Awareness Event Planning

ACCE made meaningful progress in planning its upcoming Cancer Awareness Event, scheduled for Spring 2026.

Planning Progress in 2025

- Initial event concept and planning launched in August
- A tentative event date was proposed for April 2026
- Potential budget identified in the range of $5,000–$10,000
- Invitations were planned for various cancer experts
- Sponsorship request letters were prepared and distributed
- A dedicated volunteer/event organizer began supporting event coordination
- Venue search was underway throughout the year

By October and December, planning was progressing well, with potential sponsorship conversations involving organizations such as:

- Walmart
- KW-OH

This event is expected to become a key platform for awareness, education, donor engagement, and community partnership-building.

Financial Statement

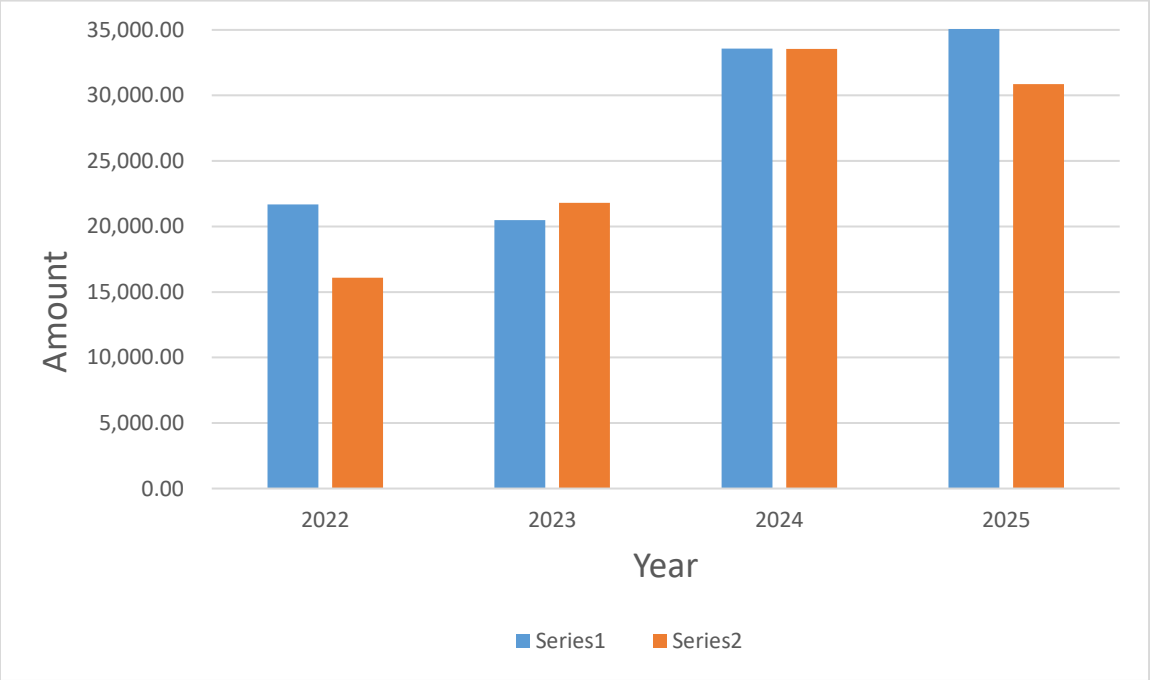
2025 Financial Overview

ACCE continued to operate with careful stewardship of limited resources while prioritizing direct patient support and organizational development. Summary of the 2025 financial statements is as given below

ACCE INCOME STATEMENT DECEMBER 31 2025	
Donations (2025 opening balance)	3,853.68
Total Revenue Receipted	25,191.68
Total Donations un-receipted	13,433.27
Total Expenses	-30,871.64
Ending Balance January 2 2025	11,606.99
ACCE BALANCE SHEET DECEMBER 31 2025	
Cash	11,606.99
Equity	11,606.99

Donations and Expense Chart by Year

100% of all donations go directly toward cancer treatment



Financial Reflection

Despite operating within a constrained funding environment, ACCE continued to deliver meaningful support to cancer patients while investing in the systems, branding, and volunteer infrastructure needed for future growth.

The year-end results indicate encouraging progress in donor support, while also reinforcing the need to:

- grow monthly giving,
- diversify funding streams,
- secure sponsorships and grants,
- and strengthen long-term financial sustainability.

Special Mentions and Thank Yous

ACCE's work in 2025 would not have been possible without the dedication, generosity, and compassion of many individuals and groups.

To Our Donors

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to every donor who gave throughout the year, whether through monthly contributions, one-time gifts, or behind-the-scenes support. Your generosity made it possible for patients to access treatment and receive urgently needed assistance.

To Our Board of Directors

Thank you to the Board for your leadership, consistency, and commitment to governance, fundraising, strategic planning, and patient-centered decision-making.

Special thanks to those who took on additional responsibilities in:

- donor engagement
- communications
- strategic planning
- publication and reporting

To Our Volunteers

A special thank you goes to our growing volunteer teams whose energy and creativity helped transform ACCE's public presence in 2025.

We especially acknowledge volunteers supporting:

- content creation
- graphic design
- website updates
- video development
- event planning
- digital communications

Your work has strengthened the organization in visible and lasting ways.

To Our Campus Chapters

Thank you to the students and young leaders at:

- University of Waterloo

- Wilfrid Laurier University
- University of Guelph
- McMaster University
- University of Western Ontario

Your enthusiasm and advocacy are helping build a new generation of cancer equity champions.

To Our Patient Advocates and Local Contacts

We are deeply grateful to the trusted individuals supporting patient coordination at KATH and KBTH, and to the ACCE-supported patient who volunteered as a patient navigator. Your service has made a direct difference in the lives of patients navigating complex and often overwhelming care pathways.

To Our Partners and Supporters

Thank you to all individuals, community groups, and prospective sponsors who engaged with ACCE during the year. Even when immediate support did not materialize, every conversation helped increase visibility for our mission.

Future Goals from Our Strategic Plan

In December 2025, the ACCE 2026 Strategic Plan was reviewed and accepted by the Board. This plan sets the direction for the organization's next phase of growth and impact.

Strategic Priorities Moving Forward

1. **Expand Patient Support Capacity**

ACCE will work to increase fundraising so that more patients can receive support without being placed on waiting lists. A key priority is ensuring more timely intervention for patients facing urgent treatment delays.

2. **Strengthen Patient Navigation**

Building on the success of volunteer navigation support at KBTH, ACCE aims to explore opportunities to:

- formalize patient navigation support
- potentially place navigators at both KBTH and KATH
- improve patients' ability to access treatment and complete required processes efficiently

3. **Increase Revenue and Donor Retention**

Future fundraising efforts will focus on:

- expanding monthly donor participation
- attracting new individual donors
- pursuing grants and sponsorships
- strengthening donor stewardship and communication

- working toward and beyond the $50,000 annual fundraising target

4. **Build Brand Visibility and Public Trust**

ACCE will continue to strengthen its:

- website
- newsletter
- social media presence
- public communications
- professional identity

These efforts will help improve public trust, donor confidence, and awareness of cancer care inequities.

5. **Deepen Volunteer and Youth Engagement**

The organization plans to continue developing:

- volunteer teams
- student-led ACCE chapters
- leadership pathways for young advocates and professionals

This work will help sustain organizational capacity and widen community engagement.

6. **Successfully Launch the 2026 Cancer Awareness Event**

A major goal for the coming year is to deliver a successful and impactful cancer awareness event that will:

- educate the public
- raise awareness about cancer care inequities
- strengthen partnerships
- inspire donors and sponsors
- elevate ACCE's profile in the community

7. **Evaluate Strategic Memberships and Partnerships**

ACCE will monitor the value of memberships such as the Kitchener-Waterloo Chamber of Commerce and assess which partnerships best support fundraising, visibility, and mission advancement.

Closing Reflections

The story of 2025 is one of resilience, growth, and purposeful action.

While ACCE faced the ongoing challenge of limited funding against rising patient need, the organization also made significant progress in strengthening its systems, public presence, and

strategic direction. From supporting patients in crisis to building new volunteer structures and preparing for broader community engagement, 2025 laid an important foundation for the future.

As we move forward, we remain committed to our mission: advancing equitable access to cancer care and standing with patients and families when they need support most.

We are transforming cancer care with compassion and empathy

Thank you for being part of this journey.